

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names
Centre Number	Candidate Number

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

History · Paper 2: Period Study

Time: Approx. 50 minutes (Section A Timed Mock)

Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–95

Key Topic 1: The Birth of the State of Israel, 1945–63

Comprehensive 12-Page Specification Practice Pack · 1945–1963

Paper
reference

1H10/P5

You must have:

Black ink or ball-point pen. Ruler for margin checks.

Section A Total

32

Marks

Instructions: Use black ink. Complete Section A as a timed 32-mark mock (~50 mins). Complete Section B for full syllabus mastery. Mark using Section C models.

Timing Advice: 4-mark Consequence (~6 mins) · 8-mark Importance (~12 mins) · 8-mark Narrative (~12 mins).

QUESTION	FORMAT	SPECIFICATION FOCUS & HISTORICAL CONTENT	PAGE	MARKS	DONE / SCORE
SECTION A: 32-MARK TIMED MOCK EXAM (SPEND APPROX. 50 MINUTES)					
Q1 (a)	CONSEQUENCE	Irgun Bombing of King David Hotel (1946)	P2	[4]	☐ / 4
Q1 (b)	CONSEQUENCE	Israeli Military Attacks on Gaza (1955)	P2	[4]	☐ / 4
Q2	NARRATIVE	Outbreak & Key Events of the 1948–49 War	P3–4	[8]	☐ / 8
Q3 (a)	IMPORTANCE	UN Partition Plan (Resolution 181) for Statehood	P5	[8]	☐ / 8
Q3 (b)	IMPORTANCE	Creation of Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) after 1949	P6	[8]	☐ / 8
SECTION B: EXHAUSTIVE SPECIFICATION DEPTH BANK (HOMEWORK & MASTERY)					
Q4 (a)	CONSEQUENCE	Territorial Changes of the 1948–49 Armistices	P7	[4]	☐ / 4
Q4 (b)	CONSEQUENCE	Formation of the United Arab Republic (1958)	P7	[4]	☐ / 4
Q5	IMPORTANCE	Palestinian Refugee Problem (1948–56) & Relations	P8	[8]	☐ / 8
Q6	IMPORTANCE	US Financial & Diplomatic Aid to Israel (1949–63)	P9	[8]	☐ / 8
Q7	NARRATIVE	Escalation to Outbreak of the Suez Crisis (1956)	P10	[8]	☐ / 8
SECTION C: EXAMINER STANDARDS & MODEL ANSWERS (SELF & PEER ASSESSMENT)					
Ref	EXEMPLARS	Grade 8/9 Level 3 Models (Q1, Q2, Q3) & Top 3 Pitfalls	P11–12	Audit	☐ Read

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) SPECIFICATION AUDIT & REVISION CHECKLIST

Tick each official syllabus requirement once revised and mastered:

1. BRITISH WITHDRAWAL & CREATION OF ISRAEL

- ☐ Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.
- ☐ Key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.
- ☐ Key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

2. AFTERMATH OF THE 1948–49 WAR

- ☐ Territorial changes and their impact.
- ☐ The refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- ☐ The creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and the Law of Return (1950).
- ☐ US aid to Israel.
- ☐ Israel's relations with Egypt.

3. INCREASED TENSION, 1955–63

- ☐ Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- ☐ The events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956.
- ☐ The events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.

SECTION A: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 1

Answer Question 1(a) and Question 1(b). Spend approx. 6 minutes on each question.

Q1: CONSEQUENCE [8M TOTAL]

1 (a) Explain one consequence of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946). (4)

KEY FACTS BANK: 22 July 1946 Irgun militants Menachem Begin 91 casualties British Secretariat	CAUSAL CONNECTIVES: One direct consequence was... This meant that... Consequently, this led to...	RESPONSE STRUCTURE: Identify one consequence → Support with precise historical facts → Explain how this forced Britain to refer the mandate to the UN.
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1 (b) Explain one consequence of the Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955. (4)

KEY FACTS BANK: 28 February 1955 Fedayeen raids Ariel Sharon 38 Egyptian soldiers Czech Arms Deal	CAUSAL CONNECTIVES: As a consequence, ... This action provoked... This directly resulted in...	RESPONSE STRUCTURE: Identify one consequence → Support with precise facts → Explain how this humiliated Nasser and triggered the Czech Arms Deal.
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Spend approx. 12 minutes on this question. Write in continuous chronological prose.

2 Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49). (8)

(You must also use information of your own.)

Connectives: In the opening phase, ... · A decisive turning point came when... · This breathing space allowed...

[illegible]

SECTION A: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 2 (CONTINUED)

Complete your 3-stage causal account: Stage 1 (Catalyst) → Stage 2 (Turning Point) → Stage 3 (Outcome).

Q2: NARRATIVE CONTINUATION

Narrative Rule: Use linking connectives ("*Consequently*", "*This directly led to*") between paragraphs. **Check:** Both stimulus points + 1 own fact included.

Lined area for writing the narrative continuation.

Spend approx. 12 minutes on this question. Write two developed explanatory paragraphs.

Examiner Guidance: Explain why the resolution was important for providing international legal legitimacy and securing immediate diplomatic recognition for the sovereign state.

PARAGRAPH 1 FOCUS International Legal Legitimacy: Explain how Resolution 181 provided Jewish leaders with a recognised international mandate to establish a sovereign state rather than an illegal rebel territory.

PARAGRAPH 2 FOCUS Superpower Recognition & Geopolitical Foundation: Explain how the vote triggered immediate diplomatic recognition from the USA and USSR, enabling the new state to secure vital arms shipments and diplomatic standing.

SPECIFICATION FACT BANK

29 Nov 1947 vote

UN General Assembly two-thirds majority

Partition of Palestine

55% Jewish / 44% Arab split

David Ben-Gurion proclamation (14 May 1948)

US & Soviet diplomatic recognition

End of British Mandate

Outbreak of 1947–48 civil conflict

ANALYTICAL STEMS: "This was vital because..." · "Furthermore, ..." · "Without this international mandate, ..."

Spend approx. 12 minutes on this question. Write two developed explanatory paragraphs.

3 (b) Explain the importance of the creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) for the aftermath of the 1948–49 war. (8)

PARAGRAPH 1 FOCUS Centralised State Command & Internal Stability: Explain how dissolving rival political militias into a single national army under Ben-Gurion eliminated the risk of factional civil war and subordinated military force to democratic civilian control.

SPECIFICATION FACT BANK

Deterrence vs Arab neighbours

ANALYTICAL STEMS: "This was important because..." · "Consequently, ..." · "In addition, ..."

SECTION B: SPECIFICATION DEPTH BANK • CONSEQUENCE PRACTICE

Exhaustive curriculum coverage. Practice additional 4-mark consequence stems.

SPEC DEPTH: CONSEQUENCE

4 (a) Explain one consequence of the territorial changes resulting from the 1948–49 war. (4)

KEY FACTS BANK: 1949 Green Line 79% of Palestine Gaza Strip to Egypt West Bank to Jordan Divided Jerusalem	CAUSAL CONNECTIVES: One consequence was... This directly caused... As a result, ...	RESPONSE STRUCTURE: Identify territorial shift → Give specific facts (79% vs 55% UN partition) → Explain permanent loss of an independent Palestinian Arab state.
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4 (b) Explain one consequence of the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958. (4)

KEY FACTS BANK: Gamal Abdel Nasser Egypt-Syria political union Pan-Arabism Encirclement of Israel Regional destabilisation	CAUSAL CONNECTIVES: One consequence was... This meant that... Consequently, ...	RESPONSE STRUCTURE: Identify regional impact → Give precise facts → Explain how merging Egypt and Syria heightened Israeli fears of hostile encirclement.
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Exhaustive curriculum coverage. Write two developed analytical paragraphs.

5 Explain the importance of the refugee status of Palestinian Arabs for relations between Israel and Arab states after 1949. (8)

PARAGRAPH 1 FOCUS Entrenched Diplomatic Hostility: Explain how the refugee camps became enduring political symbols preventing Arab states from formally recognizing Israel.

SPECIFICATION FACT BANK

Border militarisation

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Exhaustive curriculum coverage. Write two developed analytical paragraphs.

(8)

ANALYTICAL STEMS: "This was critical because..." · "Moreover, ..." · "Without American financial support, ..."

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

SECTION B: SPECIFICATION DEPTH BANK • NARRATIVE ACCOUNT

Exhaustive curriculum coverage. Analyse the chronological sequence and causal links.

SPEC DEPTH: NARRATIVE

7 Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Suez Crisis (1956). (8)

You may use the following in your answer:

- Nationalisation of the Suez Canal (July 1956)
- British and French military intervention

(You must also use information of your own.)

CHRONOLOGICAL 3-STAGE NARRATIVE ARCHITECTURE:

STAGE 1: OUTBREAK & CATALYST (JULY 1956)

US cancels Aswan funding; Nasser nationalises Suez Canal

STAGE 2: COLLUSION & INVASION (OCT–NOV 1956)

Secret Sèvres pact; Israel invades Sinai; Anglo-French assault

STAGE 3: SUPERPOWER INTERVENTION & DEFEAT (NOV 1956)

Eisenhower forces allied retreat; Nasser elevated to Pan-Arab hero

Fact Bank: Aswan Dam loan cancellation Nasser 26 July speech Secret Sèvres agreement

Israeli Sinai invasion Port Said landings Eisenhower financial ultimatum

Connectives: The crisis began when... · In response, Britain and France... · A decisive military escalation occurred when...

Handwriting practice lines for the narrative account.

SECTION C: HIGH-SCORING EXEMPLAR RESPONSES

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 3 continuous prose exemplars with examiner annotations.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q1 & Q3

QUESTION 1: CONSEQUENCE EXEMPLAR

Full Marks · Level 2 (4/4)

Explain one consequence of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946).

One consequence of the bombing of the King David Hotel was that it shattered British political and domestic resolve to maintain the Palestine Mandate. On 22 July 1946, Irgun militants disguised as milkmen detonated explosives in the basement, killing 91 British, Arab, and Jewish administrative staff and destroying the British military secretariat. This was significant because it forced Prime Minister Clement Attlee's cabinet to conclude that keeping 100,000 troops in Palestine amid an escalating guerrilla insurgency was financially and militarily unsustainable, directly prompting Britain in February 1947 to announce its withdrawal and refer the problem to the United Nations.

Examiner Annotation: Level 2 (4 Marks): Precise point identified in sentence 1; detailed historical facts (22 July 1946, 91 killed, Attlee cabinet, 100,000 troops); sustained causal explanation of why this led to the British referral to the UN.

QUESTION 3: IMPORTANCE EXEMPLAR

Full Marks · Level 3 (8/8)

Explain the importance of UN Resolution 181 for the creation of Israel.

UN Resolution 181 was important for the creation of Israel because it provided essential international legal legitimacy for sovereign Jewish statehood. Passed by a two-thirds majority in the United Nations General Assembly on 29 November 1947, the resolution voted to terminate the British Mandate and partition Palestine into independent Arab and Jewish states, allocating 55% of the territory to the Jewish state despite them forming only a third of the population. This international mandate was vital because it granted Jewish leaders the recognized diplomatic authority to establish a sovereign government without being dismissed as an illegal rebellion.

Furthermore, Resolution 181 was critical because it enabled David Ben-Gurion to formally proclaim the State of Israel on 14 May 1948 and immediately secure superpower recognition. Within hours of the declaration, both the United States under President Truman and the Soviet Union granted de facto recognition to the new nation based directly on the UN partition vote. Without this international legal foundation, Israel would have lacked the diplomatic backing required to establish formal foreign relations and secure emergency Czech arms shipments during the subsequent 1948–49 war.

Examiner Annotation: Level 3 (8 Marks): Two fully developed explanations; precise AO1 evidence (29 Nov 1947, 55% territory, 14 May 1948, Truman recognition); sustained analytical focus on statehood creation.

SECTION C: NARRATIVE EXEMPLAR & FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS

Official Level 3 continuous prose model answer and high-frequency pitfalls to avoid.

GRADE 8/9 MODEL: Q2

QUESTION 2: NARRATIVE ACCOUNT EXEMPLAR

Full Marks · Level 3 (8/8)

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

The Arab-Israeli War began immediately following the proclamation of the State of Israel on 14 May 1948. On 15 May, regular armies from Egypt, Transjordan, Syria, Lebanon, and Iraq invaded simultaneously. In the opening weeks, Arab forces achieved significant gains: Transjordan's Arab Legion captured East Jerusalem and besieged 100,000 Jewish residents in the New City, while Egyptian armoured columns advanced to within 20 miles of Tel Aviv. At this initial stage, the fledgling Israeli state faced imminent military collapse due to severe shortages of heavy artillery and combat aircraft.

A decisive turning point occurred on 11 June 1948 when the United Nations brokered a four-week truce. David Ben-Gurion exploited this breathing space to centralize command, dissolving rival paramilitary groups (Haganah, Irgun, and Lehi) into the unified Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) under Order No. 4. Furthermore, Israel covertly imported modern rifles, artillery, and Avia S-199 fighter aircraft from Czechoslovakia. Consequently, when fighting resumed in July (the "Ten Days"), the IDF possessed a decisive tactical advantage in firepower, air control, and coordinated leadership.

This organizational superiority directly enabled the IDF to launch devastating autumn counter-offensives. Operation Yoav broke the Egyptian blockade in the Negev, while Operation Hiram cleared the Galilee in the north. The fighting concluded with the 1949 Armistice Agreements (the Green Line), which left Israel in control of 79% of Mandatory Palestine—far exceeding the original 55% UN partition boundary. This outcome secured Israeli sovereign survival but displaced over 700,000 Palestinian Arabs into permanent refugee status (the Nakba).

Examiner Annotation: Level 3 (8 Marks): Seamless 3-stage chronological narrative; explicit causal connectives explaining how the June truce unlocked autumn counter-offensives; rich historical knowledge (Operation Yoav, Avia S-199s, Green Line).

TOP 3 FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS TO AVOID FOR KEY TOPIC 1

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|---|---|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Partition (1947) vs Armistice (1949)
Do not confuse the 1947 UN Partition Plan (Res 181, which allocated 55% of Palestine to a Jewish state) with the 1949 Armistice Green Line (which enclosed 79% following the 1948–49 War). Res 181 was never implemented as Arab leaders rejected it. | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• The Turning Point of the 1948–49 War
The decisive turning point of the 1948–49 War was NOT superior Israeli numbers at the outbreak, but the 4-week UN truce in June 1948. This allowed Israel to import Czech Avia S-199 fighters and rifles, while David Ben-Gurion unified all militias into the IDF. | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Suez 1956: Military Victory vs Political Defeat
Britain and France achieved military victory in capturing Port Said in November 1956, but suffered a catastrophic political defeat when US President Eisenhower threatened financial sanctions, forcing an immediate withdrawal and elevating Nasser into a Pan-Arab hero. |
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